# YENNY OTERO

**Founding Design Engineer · Health Products · Designing and Building Full Stack**

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## PROFILE

Developer turned designer with 20 years of experience. I started as a C++ developer at Opera (browsers on Nintendo Wii and DSi), moved into design, and now design and ship products myself, front to back, with AI coding agents: React, TypeScript, Supabase (Postgres) and Python. I built Bachata Connect solo in five months for 344 guests, and I judge design by what people do: I removed a feature after testing it and changed a wristband's job when only 38% of holders used it. Before that I took Pepper, Israel's first digital bank, from zero and led TSB's app from 1.8 to 4.6 stars. Executive MBA (Warwick).

## KEY STRENGTHS

- **Design and build the whole product:** Bachata Connect, solo: UX, React and TypeScript frontend, Supabase Postgres backend, Python data scripts, tests and deploys, built with Claude and AI coding agents.
- **Complex information made clear:** one app with different views for participants, reviewers, door staff, teachers and admins; admin views that page every row after I found a survey count of 45 was really 72.
- **Designing for people who struggle with technology:** Amplifon hearing care, where I redefined the brief (6 awards); inclusive design for vulnerable customers at Vanquis; wristband check-in for 344 arrivals.
- **Zero to one and fast shipping:** Pepper, Israel's first digital bank, from zero (onboarding conversion 30% to 85%); TSB's app and design system from 1.8 to 4.6 stars with no product managers.

## EXPERIENCE

**Head of Customer Experience** | Vanquis Bank — Apr 2023 – Apr 2026

- Owned customer-experience strategy across consumer-finance products serving 1.7M+ customers.
- Led early-intervention strategy for credit cards and vehicle finance; redesigned journeys for 109,500+ customers.

**Head of Design, Customer Experience & Innovation** | TSB Bank — 2018 – 2023

- Took the mobile app from 1.8 to 4.6 App Store stars and led the design and delivery of the new app with the IBM engineering team.
- Built the in-house design function from zero (up to 17 people). With no product managers, my team led the roadmap.

**Lead Product Designer** | SapientRazorfish (client: Amplifon, Italy) — 2017 – 2018

- Ran research with users and audiologists across Italy; reframed a control app into a behaviour-change companion.
- 6,500+ downloads in four months; six international awards including The Drum DADI and EPICA.

**Co-founder & Director** | Neon Lighthouse Ltd — 2023 – Present

*AI product studio: designing, validating and building AI-native products.*

- Build AI-native products from discovery to production with Claude, Next.js, Supabase and Vercel.
- Building Breathing Room, a conversational AI financial-wellbeing coach grounded in my MBA research on financial avoidance.

**Founder & Product Lead** | Bachata Week / Bachata Connect — 2014 – Present

*International dance training week. I designed and built its platform end to end.*

- Built a multi-role platform (participants, reviewers, staff, teachers) solo in five months: strict TypeScript, CI that blocks failing typechecks, Playwright harness.
- Integrated Claude in production to translate expert feedback and generate digests for artists.
- Replaced a 20-minute manual registration with NFC wristband check-in: 344 arrivals over two afternoons.
- Built a rule-based recommendation engine; recommended classes sold at twice the rate of others, and 65% bought add-ons.

**Lead Product & Service Designer** | Designit — 2013 – 2017

- Redesigned breast cancer diagnosis at Oslo University Hospital: 12 weeks to 6 days, now Norway's national standard.
- Led design and the roadmap for Pepper, Israel's first digital bank, from zero: journeys and onboarding, with conversion from 30% to 85%.

**Interaction Designer** | Opera Software — 2002 – 2013

- Browsers for mobile, TV and gaming devices, including the Nintendo DSi and Wii; worked in Oslo, Tokyo and Beijing.

## EDUCATION, TOOLS & LANGUAGES

**Executive MBA, Warwick Business School** · 2023 – 2026 · Certificate in Strategy, Harvard Business School · 2023 · BSc Informatics (computer engineering), University of Oslo · 1999 – 2004

**Tools:** React, Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase, Vercel, GitHub Actions, Playwright, Claude and AI coding agents, Figma

**Languages:** Spanish (native), Italian, English and Norwegian (fluent)